

Md Ali, Ph.D., CISSP

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity executive and Virtual Chief Information Security Officer (vCISO) with 10+ years of experience spanning security strategy, enterprise risk management, offensive security, cybersecurity research, and technical leadership. Advise executive stakeholders on cybersecurity governance, organizational risk, regulatory readiness, and security program maturity across healthcare, education, and financial services. Deep technical background in penetration testing and Security Risk Assessments (SRAs), with expertise translating complex security findings into prioritized, business-aligned remediation strategies and long-term security roadmaps. Combines executive advisory and hands-on consulting experience with academic leadership, applied cybersecurity research, and cybersecurity workforce development.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Virtual Chief Information Security Officer (vCISO) – DOT Security Jan 2026 – Present

- Serve as Virtual Chief Information Security Officer and executive cybersecurity advisor across a portfolio of 15+ client organizations spanning defense, healthcare, financial services, legal services, higher education, and government, leading cybersecurity strategy, enterprise risk management, governance, and security program development.
- Routinely advise CEOs, CFOs, CIOs, senior executives, and private equity stakeholders on cybersecurity risk, security strategy, regulatory exposure, organizational priorities, and security investment decisions.
- Translate complex technical, operational, and regulatory risks into business-focused recommendations that enable executive leadership to prioritize remediation efforts, allocate resources, and make informed risk-management decisions.
- Lead enterprise security posture and maturity assessments across people, process, and technology, identifying control deficiencies, systemic risk, and opportunities to strengthen governance and security program maturity.
- Translate penetration testing, vulnerability assessment, and Security Risk Assessment (SRA) findings into prioritized remediation roadmaps based on business impact, likelihood, regulatory exposure, operational risk, and organizational objectives.
- Develop and maintain multi-phase cybersecurity roadmaps aligning security initiatives, control improvements, risk treatment activities, and compliance priorities with business objectives and evolving threat landscapes.
- Deliver executive briefings, quarterly risk reviews, and security program updates to senior leadership, communicating material risks, remediation progress, emerging threats, and strategic recommendations for continued security investment.
- Review and mature cybersecurity policies, standards, procedures, and governance frameworks to establish consistent, repeatable, and defensible enterprise risk management practices across diverse regulatory environments.

Professor & Program Coordinator (Cybersecurity) – Olive-Harvey College Aug 2024 – Present

- Lead cybersecurity academic and workforce development initiatives, aligning curriculum, technical training, and program priorities with evolving industry practices and employer needs.
- Design and deliver applied instruction across ethical hacking, penetration testing, defensive security, risk assessment, vulnerability management, and incident response.
- Develop hands-on cyber ranges, labs, and simulated enterprise security scenarios that expose students to real-world attacker methodologies, defensive decision-making, and operational security challenges.
- Collaborate with faculty, industry partners, and institutional stakeholders to strengthen cybersecurity curriculum, expand workforce readiness, and improve alignment between academic outcomes and industry expectations.

Cybersecurity Consultant – Burwood Group Inc. Aug 2022 – Dec 2025

- Led end-to-end cybersecurity consulting engagements across healthcare, higher education, and financial services, managing assessment scoping, technical execution, risk analysis, executive reporting, and remediation guidance.
- Conducted enterprise penetration testing and security assessments across external and internal networks, web applications, servers, endpoints, and business-critical systems to identify exploitable weaknesses and systemic security risks.

- Performed 25+ Security Risk Assessments annually, evaluating organizational security posture and mapping identified risks and control gaps to frameworks and regulatory requirements including NIST CSF, HIPAA, and PCI DSS.
- Translated technical vulnerabilities and assessment findings into executive-level risk narratives addressing business impact, likelihood, control deficiencies, and prioritized remediation strategies.
- Advised client cybersecurity and IT leadership on risk treatment, remediation planning, and security program improvements to reduce identified risk exposure and strengthen overall security posture.

Cybersecurity Instructor – ThriveDX

Nov 2022 – Jul 2025

- Delivered applied cybersecurity instruction across ethical hacking, network and Linux security, digital forensics, and incident response, translating complex technical concepts for diverse adult learners.
- Designed hands-on labs and simulated real-world security scenarios incorporating attacker tradecraft, defensive analysis, incident response, and risk-based decision-making.
- Mentored cybersecurity professionals and career-transitioning learners, strengthening technical competency, analytical problem-solving, and practical readiness for security roles.

Research Aide – Argonne National Laboratory

May 2022 – Aug 2022

- Conducted advanced computing research focused on large-scale quantum circuit simulation, developing parallel optimization tooling in Julia and supporting computational workloads across high-performance computing environments including Polaris and Aurora.

Research Assistant – Illinois Institute of Technology

Aug 2019 – Aug 2022

- Conducted computer systems research spanning distributed systems, operating systems, program verification, performance modeling, and worst-case execution-time analysis across complex computing environments.

EDUCATION

Capitol Technology University

May 2025

Doctor of Philosophy • Computer Science

Research Focus: AI, Cybersecurity, and Security Automation

Illinois Institute of Technology

Dec 2022

Master of Science • Computer Science

Illinois Institute of Technology

Aug 2020

Master of Science • Applied Cybersecurity & Digital Forensics

Texas State University

May 2019

Bachelor of Science • Physics & Applied Mathematics

CYBERSECURITY EXPERTISE

Security Leadership & Strategy: Security program development, executive advisory, risk prioritization, security roadmaps, governance and policy development

Governance, Risk & Compliance: NIST CSF, CIS Controls v8.1, CMMC, HIPAA, PCI DSS, Security Risk Assessments

Offensive Security: Penetration testing, vulnerability assessment, network and web application testing

Security Technologies: SentinelOne, Huntress, Cloudflare, Proofpoint, Cynomi, KnowBe4

Automation & Systems: Python, PowerShell, Bash, Linux, Windows

CERTIFICATIONS

– Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) – ISC2

– Practical Network Penetration Tester (PNPT) – TCM Security

PROFESSIONAL LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

– Founder and Faculty Advisor, Hacking Club – Olive-Harvey College (2023 – Present)

– Judge, Trace Labs Global OSINT Search Party CTF (2022– Present)

– Speaker, OWASP SnowFroc Colorado (2024)

– Guest Speaker on "Ethical Hacking" on Corporate Strategy Podcast (2024)

– Mentor, Women in Cybersecurity (WiCyS)

– Volunteer Lead, Rizal Filipino Community Center – Chicago